

Bauhaus

The most influential modernist art school of the 20th century, the Bauhaus ('house of building') took a unique approach to teaching and exerted a global impact. Its leader, Gropius, blurring distinctions between fine and applied arts, and aiming to reunite creativity and manufacturing, began by the mid-1920s to switch the focus from crafts to industrial design. Leading artists and designers taught students a wide range of arts, crafts and methods of mass-production. The curriculum included printmaking, woodwork, metalwork, ceramics and architecture, and the focus on experimentation and problem-solving had a lasting influence on arts education. In 1925 the Bauhaus moved into Gropius's purpose-built complex at Dessau, dominated by the three-storey workshop building with its full-width curtain glass wall. In 1928, the architect Hannes Meyer (1889–1954) took over from Gropius, but after incorporating his Marxist ideals, he was dismissed. In 1932, the school was moved to Berlin, under Mies van der Rohe, but it closed indefinitely when the Nazis took power in 1933.

